FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS TO HELP / SIMPLIFY ONLINE SUBMISSION OF APPLICATIONS UNDER NATIONAL MEANS-CUM-MERIT SCHOLARSHIP SCHEME (NMMSS)

Who is eligible to apply for National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme (NMMSS)?

Students belonging to any community studying in Government, Government-aided or local body schools and fulfilling the Scheme guidelines are eligible to apply for the scholarship. Students whose parental income from all sources is not more than Rs. 3,50,000/- per annum are eligible to avail the scholarship. The students should score minimum of 55 % marks or equivalent grade in Class VII examination for appearing in selection test for award of scholarship (relaxable by 5% for SC/ST students).

What is the amount of scholarship under NMMSS?

The amount of scholarship is ₹12000 per annum.

What is the general procedure for the selection of awardee students?

Each State/UT will conduct its own test at stage of class VIII for selection of students for the award of the National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship. The state Level Examination may consist of the following two tests:

i. Mental Ability Test (MAT)

ii. Scholastic Aptitude Test (SAT)

The students should score minimum of 55 % marks or equivalent grade in class VII examination for appearing in selection test conducted during class VIII for award of scholarship (relaxable by 50% for SC/ST students). The student should be studying as regular student in Government, Government-aided and local body schools.

Duration of the Test

The selection test for the National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme (NMMSS) is divided into two papers, and duration of **90 minutes** is set for each one. The total duration of the entire examination is **3 hours (180 minutes).**

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What is the criteria for selection of students?

The students must pass both the tests i.e. MAT and SAT with at least 40% marks in aggregate for these two tests. For SC/ST students, this cut off will be 32% marks.

At the time of selection for writing the NMMSS Examination, the student must have scored at least 55% marks or equivalent grade in Class VIII examination. There will be 5% relaxation in marks for SC/ST students.

Eligibility and other conditions for commencement and continuation of Scholarship at Secondary and Higher Secondary Stage:-

The awardees should get clear promotion from Class VIII to Class IX for being eligible for commencement of the scholarship as indicated above;

The scholarship at the Secondary and Higher Secondary stage or equivalent classes IX to XII is payable for a maximum period of four years for studies in India only;

No Scholarship at this stage is payable for studying diploma/certificate level courses;

For continuing the scholarship in class X and XII, the awardees should get clear promotion from class IX to Class X and from class XI to Class XII in the first attempt;

The awardees must obtain a minimum of 60% marks in Class X examination (relaxable by 5% for SC/ST students) or equivalent examination for continuation of the scholarship at higher secondary stage.

How can I apply online for scholarship?

National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme (NMMSS) is on-boarded on NSP. You can apply for fresh or renewal Scholarship under the Scheme on the National Scholarship Portal (NSP) at www.scholarships.gov.in.

What documents are needed to be uploaded on Portal while applying for Scholarship?

Two documents are required for uploading i.e. Income Certificate and Caste Certificate.

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What documents are needed to be given to the Institute/School/College for verification of online application on the Portal after applying for Scholarship?

The list of documents to be submitted by the applicant for Fresh Scholarship, under NMMSS, for verification of her/his online application by the Institute/School/College are as under:

Income Certificate of Parent/Guardian issued by the Competent Authority in the State/UT.

Caste Certificate, if applicable.

How to apply for scholarship?

First, student has to register on National Scholarship Portal (NSP) at www.scholarships.gov.in in order to get OTR ID. Next, the OTR must be used to login on NSP Application Form module. Student's demographic details and photograph will be automatically fetched from OTR.

What is One-Time Registration (OTR)?

One-Time Registration (OTR) is a unique number provided to streamline the registration process. Users register with their mobile number and complete eKYC (electronic Know Your Customer). Once this process is complete, an OTR number is generated and sent to the user's phone. This unique number allows users to log in and access various services without needing to re-register. The OTR number is generated once and remains valid throughout the student's academic career.

How to update demographic details?

For change in demographic details student must first update their Aadhaar details. These changes will be reflected in student's OTR profile through fresh eKYC. After updation in NSP OTR, details will be reflected in NSP Application Form.

How do I change my Domicile State?

If you have already applied for a scholarship then you will not be able to change your domicile state unless you withdraw your application. Please

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note all of your applications (Scholarship/ incentive) must be withdrawn. If you have even one active application, you will not be able to change your Domicile state. Additionally, you cannot withdraw your application if the application has been approved by L2 (Nodal officer) or if the scholarship payment has been released.

How can I change my Scholarship Category once my application is submitted?

If you have already applied for scholarship then you will not be able to change your category of Scholarship unless you withdraw your application. Please note all of your applications (Scholarship/ incentive) must be withdrawn. If you have even one active application, you will not be able to change your category of Scholarship. Additionally, you cannot withdraw your application if it has been approved by L2 (Nodal officer) or if the scholarship payment has been released.

When can I withdraw my application?

You can withdraw your application at any time during the application process. Please note that you will not be able to withdraw your application if any of the following conditions are met –

If the application has been approved by L2 (Nodal officer)

If the scholarship payment has been released.

Can I revoke my renewal application again after withdrawing?

Yes, you can enable your renewal application again after withdrawing. To do so, go to 'My Applications' page and click on the 'Revoke Application' button for the desired application. Please note that you cannot revoke your scholarship application if you fail the following conditions –

You already have another active scholarship application and want to revoke another scholarship application.

Application Date is closed.

How do I change my password?

You may login in OTR to change the password.

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What are the benefits of One-Time Registration?

One-Time Registration (OTR) offers several advantages:

• It helps in streamlining the registration process as OTR simplifies the registration process by providing users with a unique number after completing e-KYC. This eliminates the need for repetitive registration steps across different services.

• It is convenient for the users as they only need to register once with their mobile number and complete e-KYC to receive their OTR number. This reduces the hassle of filling out multiple registration forms for various services.

• The OTR number is generated once and remains valid throughout the student's academic career, providing a consistent and stable identifier for all related services.

• By eliminating the need for repetitive registrations, OTR enhances the overall user experience, making it more convenient for traceability and tracking to access multiple services.

Which portals typically use One-Time Registration?

The NSP portal and other state portals may implement One-Time Registration (OTR) to simplify the registration process and ensure de-duplication.

Is One-Time Registration mandatory for all services on NSP?

Yes, One-Time Registration is mandatory for all services on NSP. It serves as the username for logging in and is also required to complete the face authentication process.

What documents/information do I need to have ready to create my OTR?

To create your OTR, student will need the following Documents/Information:

Active mobile number

Aadhaar number

Mobile number linked with Aadhaar

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NPCI Seeding status (desired)

Can I update my information after completing the One-Time Registration (OTR) process?

Yes, you can update most of your information, including Aadhaar-related details and other personal information. This ensures that your profile remains accurate and up to date. If your Aadhaar information changes, you will need to perform eKYC and face authentication again to update your details.

How frequently should I update my One-Time Registration information?

It is advisable to review and update your OTR information periodically, especially if there are changes in your personal details or contact information. Keeping your profile up to date ensures accuracy and enhances the effectiveness of the OTR system.

What is a Reference no?

A Reference no is assigned when users provide their own Aadhaar or their guardian's Aadhaar. It is sent to the registered mobile number to complete face authentication and to generate OTR number.

What is Aadhaar based Payment?

Applicants/Students who have entered Aadhaar in their online application correctly and if their Aadhaar is linked to any of their bank account, in such cases the amount of Scholarship will be credited to that Aadhaar linked bank account only even if the student has mentioned any other non-Aadhaar linked bank account in her/his online application.

Which fields can I edit before final submission of application?

You can edit all details except "Registration Details". It may be noted that once you 'finally submit' your application it will be forwarded to the next level and after that you cannot edit further.

Which fields in the application form are mandatory?

Fields provided with red asterisk (*) mark are mandatory fields.

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Do I have to fill up the online application in one sitting?

No. You can fill up the online application in many sittings using 'Save Draft', until you are satisfied that you have entered all desirable fields correctly. The software provides facility to save your application at every stage until you click on 'Submit' button.

Is there any Application ID?

Yes. An Application ID will be provided to the candidate once his/her application is submitted online. It will be conveyed to candidates through SMS. Students should remember their ID as it will be required while applying for renewal during subsequent years. Receipt of ID does not give in itself a guarantee of award of scholarship.

What should I do, if my Institute name is not appearing in the dropdown list of Institutes in application form?

You may ask your institute to contact the concerned State Nodal officer of NMMSS for their registration through U-DISE code available on NSP portal.

What should I do, if I do not find my Course name in the dropdown menu?

You should immediately approach the institute (where you are studying) to login their account and add the concerned Course from the Master course list. Thereafter, you may be able to find the desired course name in your online application.

What should I do before making any call/enquiry/representation at helpdesk of National Informatics Centre (NIC) and/or Ministry of Education?

You should first check your online status on NSP and then make any call/enquiry/representation at helpdesk of National Informatics Centre (NIC) and/or Ministry of Education (MoE).

What is the process of verification of my application?

Your application must be verified at School/Institute level and then at domicile district level. You may contact the concerned verification authorities

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for online verification of your application within the timeline given on the NSP portal. Ministry of Education will release the scholarship amount, only if your application is verified and approved by all verification authorities. In case, your application is rejected by any of the concerned authorities due to any reason, you will not get the scholarship amount.

How can I check whether the amount of my scholarship is credited in my bank account or not?

You may check the transaction status on PFMS portal i.e. www.pfms.nic.in under "Know Your Payment "(https://pfms.nic.in/static/NewLayoutCommonContent.aspx?RequestPagename=s tatic/KnowYourPayment.aspx) option on the home page.

What should I do for the successful payment of Scholarship in my bank account?

You are advised to keep your bank account active to receive the scholarship amount (till the disbursal of scholarships). Confirm from your bank that your account is not dormant /closed and also be sure that your account is seeded with aadhaar to enable DBT payments. You should ensure that your account is free from transaction limit or any other conditions till the disbursal of scholarship is made in your account, to avoid any chance of transaction failure/return of scholarship amount.

How do I know the name and address of Nodal Officer/ State Department of my State?

The name and contact details of the Nodal Officer/State Department of all States/UTs are available in home page of National Scholarship Portal (NSP) (https:// scholarships.gov.in/public/ nodalOfficersList/ MCMscheme.pdf)

What should I do if I come to know after final submission, that my application is 'defected' by the Institute/District/State verifying authority?

In case the application is marked as 'defected' by the Institute/District/State, the application will be reverted to the student for correction of the defect in his/her application form. You can correct the defect and re-submit the application for re-verification within the timelines

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given on NSP. For such cases, INO and DNO may ensure that the application is eligible under the scheme guidelines.

Can I take print-out of my application at any stage?

You can take the print out of your fresh or renewal application any number of times once you submit and finalize the application.

Checklist for the application not getting rejected on the portal

- Confirm you meet **all** eligibility requirements for the specific scholarship scheme (e.g., minimum percentage, income ceiling, course of study, category, domicile state).
- Your name, Date of Birth, and Gender must **match exactly** across all documents, especially the **Aadhaar Card**, **Bank Passbook**, and **Educational records kept in School Office.**
- Collect all necessary documents for your specific scheme.
- Ensure Income, Caste/Community, and Domicile certificates are **valid, recent, and issued by the competent authority** (e.g., Tehsildar/SDM).
- Scan and upload **clear, readable copies** of all documents in the specified format (PDF/JPEG) and within the size limit.
- Ensure your **Aadhaar is correctly linked to your bank account (DBT enabled)**. The bank account must be **active** and preferably in your name (mandatory for Post-Matric and above).
- Fill in every field of the online application form **accurately** (e.g., marks, school/college details, fee amount).
- Complete and **Final Submit** your application within the scheme's time limit on NSP.

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